

Scientific Director, CHD2

Organization: Coalition to Cure CHD2 (CCC)

Location: US-based remote

About Coalition to Cure CHD2

Coalition to Cure CHD2 (CCC) is a US-based nonprofit dedicated to improving the lives of individuals with CHD2-related neurodevelopmental disorders by funding research, increasing education, and building a global community. CCC was founded in 2020 and has developed an international CHD2 community and research mission focused on advancing safe and effective treatments. CCC is a 501(c)(3) tax-exempt public charity and describes itself as a largely volunteer-run organization.

Position Summary

The Scientific Director, is the primary scientific leader for CCC and is responsible for developing and executing a multi-year research strategy across basic, translational, and clinical science relevant to CHD2-related disorders. The role includes leading CCC's efforts to evaluate and advance antisense oligonucleotide (ASO)-based therapeutic approaches for CHD2, from concept through preclinical proof-of-biology and early clinical readiness. The Scientific Director will manage the research portfolio, cultivate collaborations across academia, industry, and clinical networks, and serve as a key scientific voice to families, donors, and external partners.

Key Responsibilities

Research strategy

- Evaluate and maintain CCC's CHD2 research roadmap, including strategic priorities, milestones, and gap analyses across mechanism, models, biomarkers, and therapeutic development.

- Align the research portfolio with organizational strategy, available resources, and community priorities.
- Monitor scientific developments in CHD2 and adjacent neurodevelopmental and epilepsy fields to identify actionable opportunities.

CHD2 molecular medicines, including antisense development

- Direct CCC's strategy for CHD2 molecular therapy development, including therapeutic rationale, target assessment, and modality prioritization.
- Oversee external collaborations supporting therapeutic design, screening, optimization, and preclinical evaluation.
- Guide development and use of relevant cellular, neural-derived stem cell, and animal models to assess pharmacology, pharmacokinetics/pharmacodynamics, safety, and central nervous system distribution.
- Shape translational plans for CHD2 ASO programs, including biomarkers, outcome measures, regulatory strategy inputs, and early-stage clinical readiness.
- Track advances in nucleic acid therapeutics, delivery platforms, and regulatory precedent relevant to CHD2 and rare neurodevelopmental disorders.

Portfolio and program management

- Design, launch, and oversee grant programs, sponsored research, and contracted scientific projects that support CCC's mission.
- Define project goals, deliverables, budgets, and timelines; monitor progress and ensure scientific rigor and ethical conduct.
- Help establish consistent standards for reporting, milestone review, and assessment of scientific impact.
- Manage pre-clinical resources including, biorepository, cell models, etc.

Scientific advisory and partnerships

- Serve as the primary staff liaison to CCC's Scientific Advisory Board, including meeting planning, agenda development, and follow-up on recommendations.
- Translate scientific advisory input into actionable decisions and portfolio adjustments.
- Build and maintain productive relationships with academic investigators, clinicians, contract research organizations, biotechnology partners, associated rare disease organizations, and data initiative collaborators.
- Support and expand collaboration with relevant registries, natural history efforts, and data initiatives, including CHD2-related community research programs.

Scientific communication and community engagement

- Communicate complex CHD2 science clearly to diverse audiences, including families, donors, advocates, and research partners.
- Prepare and review scientific summaries, presentations, website content, white papers, and donor-facing materials.
- Represent CCC at scientific and advocacy meetings and communicate major developments back to the community.
- Integrate patient and caregiver perspectives into research prioritization, dissemination, and program planning.
- Lead CCC's biannual Meeting of the Minds Scientific Symposium and annual scientific portion of the CCC Family Conference by developing the agenda, identifying and inviting speakers, and defining objectives.

Fundraising and organizational support

- Partner with executive leadership on scientific strategy, budgeting, and external relationship development.
- Contribute scientific content and strategic input for fundraising, grant applications, and philanthropic outreach.

- Support a lean, mission-driven operating model in a highly collaborative nonprofit environment.

Qualifications

Education and experience

- PhD, MD, or equivalent terminal degree in neuroscience, genetics, molecular biology, pharmacology, or a related field.
- Progressive experience in scientific leadership, translational research, portfolio management, or therapeutic development in academia, industry, or the nonprofit sector.
- Strong background in rare neurological disease, neurodevelopmental disorders, epilepsy, chromatin biology, or related translational neuroscience fields.
- Experience with nucleic acid therapeutics, including antisense oligonucleotides, siRNA, or related modalities, is preferred.
- Experience working with rare disease foundations, patient advocacy organizations, or cross-sector scientific collaborations is highly desirable.

Skills and competencies

- Strategic scientific leadership with the ability to define long-range research priorities and convert them into operational plans.
- Strong working knowledge of translational drug development, especially for central nervous system and rare disease indications.
- Ability to manage complex external collaborations, budgets, timelines, and milestone-driven programs.
- Excellent written and verbal communication skills, including the ability to translate technical science for non-scientific audiences.

- Comfort operating in a remote, entrepreneurial, mission-driven environment with a high degree of ownership and flexibility.

Working Conditions

- This is a US-based remote position.
- Periodic travel is expected for scientific meetings, partner visits, and community events.
- The Scientific Director will work closely with CCC leadership, its Scientific Advisory Board, research collaborators, and community stakeholders.

Compensation and Benefits

Compensation will be commensurate with experience and aligned with CCC's budget and market benchmarks for scientific leadership roles. Specific salary range, benefits, and employment classification will be discussed during the recruitment process.

Equal Opportunity Statement

Coalition to Cure CHD2 is committed to building an inclusive environment that reflects the diversity of the CHD2 community. CCC welcomes applicants from all backgrounds and does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, national origin, disability, age, or veteran status, consistent with applicable law.

To Apply

Please submit a CV or NIH Biosketch along with a brief statement addressing:

1. Why this opportunity interests you.
2. One idea you believe could accelerate progress in ultra-rare neurodevelopmental disorders.

Send materials to: Laura Marks, Executive Director

Email: laura@curechd2.org

Subject Line: Scientific Director Application